Alessandro Sellitto

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Academic Position

Postdoctoral Researcher in Computational Economics, IMT Business School — October 2026–Present

Fields of Interest

Industrial Organization, Digital Economics, Applied Microeconomic Theory

Education

PhD in Economics, University of Milan and University of Pavia — 2023–Present
Dissertation: Essays in Digital Economics (submitted)
Supervisor: Marcella Nicolini
M.A. in Economics, summa cum laude, University of Salerno — 2023
B.A. in Economics and Management, University of Salerno — 2020

Research

WORKING PAPERS

The Cost of Exercising Rights: Consent Design in Data-Driven Platforms

Under Review

Abstract. Digital platforms can grant users formal privacy rights while making those rights costly to exercise. This paper studies consent design in advertising-funded platforms that choose opt-out frictions before users choose platforms and consent. Higher refusal costs expand monetizable data and may improve data-driven quality, but burden users who refuse. With captive users, platform-chosen frictions are excessive when the marginal refusal burden exceeds the quality value of induced consent, and insufficient when the reverse holds. Under competition, privacy-sensitive users sort across platforms, so refusal costs can repel or attract demand.

Implications of LLM Integration in Advertising

With Eduardo M. Azevedo and Pinar Yildirim

Abstract. We examine how richer query information changes the economics of search advertising. We model the move from keyword to semantic and conversational search as a refinement of the platform's information about query-level click-through rates. Under a fixed weighted second-price auction, finer information improves matching but has an ambiguous effect on revenue because it can thin competition within realized auctions. When the platform can adapt its mechanism, finer information raises expected revenue. Conversational search also creates a timing problem, as delaying an ad may reveal a more valuable commercial state.

Research Visits and Affiliations

Toulouse School of Economics — January 2026
Visiting PhD Researcher; host: Andrew Rhodes
European Commission, Joint Research Centre, Digital Economy Unit, Ispra — April–August 2025
JRC Scientific Trainee; host: Néstor Duch-Brown
Weizenbaum Institute for the Networked Society, Berlin — February 2025
Visiting PhD Researcher; host: Volker Stocker
Düsseldorf Institute for Competition Economics — October 2024–March 2025
Visiting PhD Researcher; host: André Romahn; Research Affiliate since April 2025

Conferences

5th Workshop on UK Digital Economics, University of Cambridge — November 2026
4th Milan PhD Economics Workshop, Bocconi University — May 2026
BU Platform Strategy Research Symposium (PhD Track), Questrom School of Business — July 2025
PLAMADISO Workshop on Digital Economics and Policy — July 2025

Seminars

Institut Mines-Télécom Business School — July 2026

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics (Undergraduate), University of Milan — Fall 2025
Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics (Undergraduate), University of Milano-Bicocca — Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant, Management (Undergraduate), University of Salerno — Summer 2021
Tutor for Students with Learning Disabilities, University of Salerno — Spring 2021

Research Experience

Research Assistant, IGIER–Bocconi University — July–December 2024

Policy Writing

Generative AI Outlook Report, European Commission, Joint Research Centre — June 2025
Underwater Archaeological Tourism: Demand Characteristics, Supply Structure and Growth Levers, SRM–Centro Ricerche e Studi — October 2025

Summer Schools

Naples Summer School in Economics and Finance, University of Naples Federico II — 2026
Chicago School in Experimental Economics, University of Chicago — 2024
Industrial Organization Summer School in Platform Economics, University of East Anglia — 2024
Cost-Benefit Analysis Summer School, CSIL Milan (full scholarship) — 2024

Professional Experience

Research Assistant, Fondazione ResPublica, Milan — Sep. 2022–Sep. 2023
Junior Business Analyst and Analyst Consultant, Capgemini, Milan — Feb.–Aug. 2022
Operations Intern, Joinrs, Milan — Jun.–Aug. 2018

Technical Skills and Languages

Programming: Python, Stata, Mathematica.
Research tools: Git, GitHub, LaTeX, Qualtrics, QGIS.
Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent).

References

Available upon request.